

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« ...Anytime we come to the tournament, we want to win. That's the first goal. I'm trying to be focused on the first part. Then, if I'll be able to finish the year as number one, it'll be amazing and I'll be super happy.

— Aryna Sabalenka, ahead of WTA Finals in Saudi Arabia »



« Of course, I am thinking about this. I am trying at first to gain confidence about the elements I had last season. — Russian figure skater Kamila Valieva on resuming her competitive career after her four-year ban for failing a drug test ends in 2025 »

3

At just three years, eight months, and 19 days, Anish Sarkar **(left, in pic)** became the youngest-rated chess player in history. Born on January 26, 2021, Anish made his debut in competitive chess with the West



Bengal state Under-9 Open in October, securing an impressive 5.5 out of 8 points and finishing 24th overall, defeating two rated players — Arav Chatterjee and Ahilaan Baishya. He got an opportunity to play against India No. 1 and World No. 4 Grandmaster Arjun Erigaisi in a simultaneous exhibition match during the Bengal Rapid Rating Open. Just a week later, Anish tested his skills again in the West Bengal state Under-13 Open, where he met the requirement of facing five rated players, ultimately earning him an initial FIDE rating of 1555. In doing so, he surpassed the previous record set by Tejas Tiwari, who had become the youngest FIDE-rated player at five years.

WORLD RECORD



Ethiopia's Yomif Kejelcha broke the men's half marathon world record, finishing in 57 minutes and 30 seconds at the Medio Maraton de Valencia in Spain to shave one second off the previous mark set by Kenya's Jacop Kiplimo in Lisbon in 2021. Kejelcha, who holds the world indoor mile record, broke away from Kenyans Daniel Mateiko and Isaia Kipkoech to win the race in record time. REUTERS